

Conversation

#03

CONVERSATION

A FAMILY IN COURT

Teacher's note: get 6 pieces of paper, number them 1 to 6 and have each student draw one, to see which character they will be.

An ex-wife and ex-husband, divorce 15 years before are in court. They have 2 sons: one is 18, the other, 16. The 18-year old one managed to enter public college but his brother needs to go to a private school to stand more chances in the future. The ex-wife wants the 16-year old one to be given R\$800 month to pay for high school tuition and other expenses, such as transport and food. She claims that neither she nor the son can afford it.

1. **Ex-wife:** you are 38, a housewife. You married again and now you have 2 other boys, who are 3 and 8. Your 16-year old son's tuition costs R\$480 a month and needs to commute 12 kilometers to go to school and another 12 to come back every day. You claim that the **Father** is not unemployed. According to you, he actually earns more than R\$4.000 and has 2 small apartments which he rents for R\$1.200 each. Therefore, actually, according to you, the Father has an income of R\$6.200 a month.
2. **Father:** you are 47 and you have been unemployed for the past 16 months. You have two sons with your **Ex-wife** and 2 boys, an 11-year old and an 8-month old, with your present wife. You live with your wife and kids in a house rented by your brother-in-law. The same day you were fired, you had a stroke and stayed at the hospital for 9 days. You claim that the rent you receive from the two apartments totals R\$900 and one of your tenants fell behind on rent 6 months ago. You also claim that. Because of your age, it has not been easy for you to find a steady job, though you have been trying ever since. You do odd jobs for your last employer and you get roughly R\$300 for that. You say you cannot afford to give your son R\$480 a month because you have a pre-toddler and an 8-year old to take care of.
3. **Judge:** you say that, although son is of age, the law demands that parents pay for offspring's tuition if they are going to school and are not able to work to pay for it. You must also exercise your discretion and take into consideration that the **Father** has a baby and an 8-year old to raise.
4. **Witness 1: Ex-wife** called you in. you know the **Father** and you do not believe he can live on R\$900 a month.
5. **Witness 2: Father** called you in. You know the **Son** and you know that he works part-time at a drugstore, where he earns R\$600 a month.
6. **Social worker:** You obviously cannot be neither for the **Father** nor for the **Ex-wife**. You must listen to both and advise the judge. You must also exercise your discretion and take into consideration that the father has a baby and a 8-year-old to raise.

COMPOSITION

Write about a relationship within your family that is not very good and explain why this is the case today. What do you imagine the relationship will be like in the future?

Full name: _____

Theme:_____

Title: _____

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.